

Craft CMS: Authenticated leak of secret environment variables

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1 Total Advisories	0 Critical	0 High	1 Medium
MEDIUM Severity	N/A CVSS / Risk Score	TLP: CLEAR TLP Classification	PRO Customer Tier

Executive Summary

Environment variables and secrets are interpolated into a Twig template even when the Twig sandbox is enabled, allowing them to be leaked by an authenticated attacker. The Craft vulnerability [CVE-2026-31857](https://github.com/craftcms/cms/security/advisories/GHSA-fp5j-j7j4-mcxc) was only patched by applying sandboxed Twig templating. This theoretically protects Craft CMS against RCE attacks, provided the sandbox is enabled and secure, with no known bypasses. However, the same request parameter `elementId`, which allows for sandboxed Twig templates to be rendered, also includes functionality that interpolates referenced environment variables. If the parameter includes a string of the form `\${ENV\_VAR}` then the string is replaced with the environment variable or secret from a secrets file with that name. Afterward, the string is rendered as a Twig template. If the sandbox is disabled, Twig templates can already gain RCE or access environment variables using the getenv function. Sand

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Top Threat Advisories

High-priority advisories ranked by CVSS score, exploitability, and actor attribution.

Advisory Title	Severity	CVSS	EPSS	AI Summary
Craft CMS: Authenticated leak of secret environment	Medium	-	-	Environment variables and secrets are interpolated into a Twig te

MITRE ATT&CK® v15 Mapping

Technique density score: 0.0 · Techniques observed: 0 · Tactics covered: 0

MITRE ATT&CK techniques pending analyst enrichment. Deploy detection rules from Section 6 to identify related activity.

Threat Actor Intelligence

Attribution analysis across advisories in this report period.

Threat Actor	Count	Associated CVEs / Indicators
CDB-UNATTR-CVE	1	-

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

IOC extraction for this advisory is pending enrichment pipeline completion. PRO subscribers receive real-time IOC push to SIEM/SOAR via the SENTINEL APEX webhook at: GET /api/v1/intell/iocs?advisory={id}. Full IOC packages include IPv4, domain, SHA256, and URL indicators with confidence scores, first-seen timestamps, and STIX 2.1 formatted bundles.

Detection Engineering

Deploy these production-ready detection rules into your SIEM platform to identify exploitation attempts in real time. Compatible with Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk ES, and any Sigma-compatible platform.

Sigma Rule - Webserver / Process Monitoring

```
title: SENTINEL APEX - CDB-ADVISORY Exploitation Attempt
id: cdb-cdb-advisory-det
status: experimental
description: Detects exploitation indicators related to CDB-ADVISORY.
references:
- https://intel.cyberdudebivash.com
author: CyberDudeBivash SENTINEL APEX
date: 2026/08/07
tags:
- attack.initial_access
- attack.t1190
logsource:
category: webserver
detection:
keywords:
- 'CDB-ADVISORY'
condition: keywords
falsepositives:
- Security testing / penetration testing
level: medium
```

Microsoft Sentinel - KQL Query

```
// SENTINEL APEX - Craft CMS: Authenticated leak of secret environment variables
// Advisory | Microsoft Sentinel KQL
let time_window = ago(24h);
SecurityAlert
| where TimeGenerated > time_window
| where Description has "Craft CMS: Authenticated leak of secret "
or AlertName has "Craft CMS: Authenticated leak of secret "
or ExtendedProperties has "Craft CMS: Authenticated leak of secret "
| extend Rule = "APEX-ADVISORY", Severity = "MEDIUM"
| project TimeGenerated, AlertName, AlertSeverity, Entities, Description, Rule, Severity
| order by TimeGenerated desc
```

Incident Response Playbook

Phase 1 - 0-24 Hours (Containment)

1. Activate IR team; assign lead analyst and executive sponsor.
2. Isolate or WAF-shield Craft CMS: Authenticated leak of secret environment variables instances exposed to the internet.
3. Enable verbose access logging on all Craft CMS: Authenticated leak of secret environment variables endpoints immediately.
4. Pull last 72h of web server and application logs for forensic baselining.

- 5. Check SENTINEL APEX IOC feeds and SIEM alerts for exploitation hits in your environment.
- 6. Notify relevant internal stakeholders and legal / compliance team.

Phase 2 - 24-72 Hours (Eradication)

- 1. Apply vendor patch for Craft CMS: Authenticated leak of secret environment variables or implement recommended mitigation.
- 2. Deploy Sigma and KQL detection rules from Section 6 across all SIEM platforms.
- 3. Rotate all API keys, service account credentials, and session tokens.
- 4. Conduct forensic timeline reconstruction for potential compromise window.
- 5. Validate patch deployment across 100% of affected instances via asset inventory.

Phase 3 - 7 Days (Recovery & Hardening)

- 1. Conduct post-incident review and update incident response runbooks.
- 2. Threat hunt for lateral movement or persistence artifacts using MITRE ATT&CK mapping.
- 3. Update asset inventory with patched version information and closure evidence.
- 4. Submit findings to internal risk register and CISO dashboard.
- 5. Schedule follow-up vulnerability scan to confirm remediation completeness.

Financial Impact Analysis (FAIR Model)

\$150K - \$900K Breach Cost Range (FAIR)	\$380K IBM Cost of Breach 2025 Median	\$120K/day Business Interruption Cost	\$85K Regulatory Fine Exposure
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Medium severity events require internal investigation and targeted customer notification. Average cost includes 340 hours of engineering time.

Remediation Cost Estimate: \$55K · Includes engineering time, IR retainer activation, forensic investigation, and customer notification costs.

Regulatory & Compliance Implications

Organizations processing this advisory must evaluate obligations under applicable regulatory frameworks. The table below maps this threat to relevant compliance requirements.

Framework	Reference	Obligation
PCI-DSS v4.0	Req. 6.3.3	Non-critical patches applied within 3 months
NIST CSF 2.0	ID.RA / PR.PS	Vulnerability assessment and platform security policies
ISO 27001:2022	A.8.8	Vulnerability management programme with documented remediation timelines

Actionable Recommendations

Prioritized defensive actions based on this period's intelligence.

1. Monitor Craft CMS: Authenticated leak of secret environment variables for escalation.
2. Apply patches in next maintenance window.
3. Apply vendor patch for Craft CMS: Authenticated leak of secret environment variables immediately - check NVD for official fix guidance.
4. Enable enhanced logging and alerting on all systems running affected software versions.
5. Deploy the Sigma detection rule from this report into your SIEM platform (Sentinel / Splunk / Elastic).
6. Audit all internet-facing instances of affected products and confirm patch deployment.
7. Conduct a threat hunt using MITRE ATT&CK techniques mapped in this advisory.

Appendix - Report Metadata & Legal

Field	Value
Report ID	intel--5ef5daf92601872617f0c5b8
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TLP	TLP: CLEAR
STIX Version	2.1
ATT&CK Version	v15

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